

Ivy Graduate Programs Student Handbook

Master of Business Administration (MBA)
2023-2024

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Getting Started

Academic Advising

Graduate programs advising varies by academic program. See below for the advisor/Director of Graduate Education (DOGE).

Master's Degree	Advisor	Director of Graduate Education (DOGE)
Full-time MBA	Sarah Wilson	Valentina Salotti
Professional MBA	Leah Berte	Valentina Salotti
Master of Accounting	Kayla Sander and Brandi Moormann	Oleana Watanabe
Master of Healthcare Analytics and Operations	Leah Berte	Kevin Scheibe
Master of Finance	Travis Sapp	Travis Sapp
Master of Information Systems	Brandi Moormann	Ray Chen
Master of Business Analytics online program	Leah Berte	Lingyao Yuan
Master of Business Analytics residential program	Brandi Moormann	Lingyao Yuan
Master of Real Estate Development	Leah Berte	James Spiller
Master of Entrepreneurship	Brandon Mueller	Brandon Mueller
Graduate Certificate	Advisor	Director of Certificate (DOC)
Certificate in Finance	Travis Sapp	Travis Sapp
Certificate in Business Analytics for students in online program	Leah Berte	Lingyao Yuan
Certificate in Business Analytics for students in residential program	Brandi Moormann	Lingyao Yuan
Certificate in Entrepreneurship	Brandon Mueller	Brandon Mueller
Certificate in Digital Marketplace Analytics	Leah Berte	
Certificate in Enterprise Cybersecurity	Kevin Scheibe	Kevin Scheibe
Certificate in Supply Chain Management	Haozhe Chen	Haozhe Chen

Admission

Each program determines its own admission criteria, including essay/statement of purpose, letters of recommendations, resumes, and test scores. If a program requires a GMAT test score for admission, test scores are valid for five years.

The Office of Admission oversees the I-20 process for international students. The I-20 states the date a student must arrive to Iowa State. If a student will arrive after that date, the program must approve and provide a late arrival letter. For Admissions to issue such a letter, they need to know, from the admitting department, that they approve the late arrival and the last day they will allow the student to arrive. The last day Ivy graduate students may arrive late is the 6th day of the semester. A program can deny a late arrival.

AccessPlus

Iowa State University's [AccessPlus](#) is a personalized, secure university information online resource that provides accessibility to confidential student information. You can register for classes and access your class schedule, order textbooks, view/pay your university bill and financial aid information, obtain a grade report and an unofficial transcript, update your student information including address changes, etc. You can login into AccessPlus using your student ID number or password. You will receive a temporary login password with your admissions letter from Iowa State University. If you need support with logging into AccessPlus, please call the ISU Solution Center at 515-294-4000.

Career Services

Graduate Business Career Services (GBCS) is dedicated to assisting Ivy graduate students with career growth and development, and to helping employers to identify and select highly qualified candidates. GBCS works closely with graduate business students to develop a career management strategy that fits each student's professional goals and unique abilities. At the same time, GBCS staff establish close relationships with companies and hiring managers to ensure that recruiting efforts are maximized.

Ivy graduate students, with the guidance provided by GBCS, are expected to take a proactive role in career development. To that end, GBCS provide a broad range of services to enhance students' employment marketability.

It is important that Ivy graduate students take advantage of these career resources beginning at orientation and throughout your studies. Visit the [Graduate Business Career Services website](#) to learn more about the services offered.

Course Registration

Students should register for both required and elective coursework through AccessPlus during the Graduate Student registration period. Registration for spring classes occurs in late October/early November and summer and fall registration both occur in late March/early April. Students can view their exact date and time of registration on AccessPlus: Student tab à Current Student Info.

For information on course offerings, please refer to the [Schedule of Classes](#) or the [Ivy Grad Programs Course Offerings](#) list. Sample program plans and degree requirements are listed on each program's website. Students are also encouraged to work with the advisor and/or Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) for assistance on course registration.

Class Attendance and Punctuality, Expectations

Ivy graduate students are expected to attend all scheduled class meetings and to arrive for class in a timely manner. Each faculty member sets his or her policy with respect to class attendance, and excused absences are handled between the instructor and the student. An excused absence should be arranged prior to the expected missed class, if possible. If an emergency or illness arises which prevents prior notification, inform the faculty of the reason for the missed class as soon as possible. In all cases, communication with the faculty is essential.

Email: Iowa State Student Accounts

Iowa State's email platform for incoming students is Microsoft Outlook. Your Outlook account was automatically created after you received your Net-ID, and so your Iowa State email address is: [Your [Net-ID](#)][@iastate.edu](#). Your Outlook account can be accessed in your computer browser through the [Okta dashboard](#) and added to an email app on your phone, tablet, or computer.

As a student, all communication from Iowa State offices will go to your Iowa State Outlook (not a previously used email account), which can include correspondence from Admissions, Financial Aid, the Registrar's Office, your academic adviser, your instructors and others. In other words, you are responsible for checking the information that is sent to you via your Outlook account, so it is important to check it regularly, even before you arrive on campus.

English Placement Test for Non-Native Speakers and Oral English Certification Test

Source: Graduate College Handbook, sec. 4.4.3

Graduate students whose native language is not English and who do not have a bachelor's or advanced degree from ISU or a U.S. institution, or do not meet the TOEFL or IELTS exemption score range, must take the English Placement Test at the beginning of their first semester of enrollment. This test is administered by the Department of English. It must be taken in addition to TOEFL (Test of English as a Foreign Language), which is taken as part of the admissions process. A student who does not pass this examination is assigned to one or more courses in the English 99 and 101 series. This coursework must be completed during the first year of study. Registration holds are placed on the student's account if the student does not register for these classes during the first year of study. (There is a developmental course fee for the English 99 course.)

Exemption Criteria:

- *All scores below must be an official score (not an unofficial or self-reported score)*
- *SAT-EWR (Evidence-based Writing and Reading) – testing date of March 2016 or later*
- *SAT-CR (Critical Reading) – testing date before March 2016*
- *Duolingo English Test (DET) is NOT accepted for exemption from the EPT*
- *Superscores (MyBest™ Scores), which use the highest TOEFL section scores from multiple test*

dates, are not accepted for exemption from the EPT.

A graduate student whose native language is not English may be automatically exempted if one of the following is met:

1. Student has received a bachelor's, master's, or doctoral degree from a U.S. college or university
2. Student has received a bachelor's, master's, or doctoral degree from an English-speaking university outside of the U.S. As of 2016, countries outside of the U.S. that ISU considers "English-speaking" are Canada, Great Britain, New Zealand, or Australia.
3. Students enrolled in a fully online, distance-only program, do not need to take the English Placement Test and are not required to meet English language requirements beyond admission requirements.
4. Student has a TOEFL score of 600 or above (paper-based TOEFL) or 100 or above (internet-based TOEFL)
5. Student has a score of 7.5 or above on the IELTS
6. Student has a score of 72 or above on the PTE (Pearson Test of English)
7. Students who have been employed full-time (40 hours per week minimum) for at least two years in organizations that use English as the primary language for both written and spoken forms of communication. To qualify for this exemption, admitted students must provide verifiable evidence. Only students admitted to Fall 2023 and after are eligible for this exemption.

Oral English Certification Test

The Oral English Certification Test (OECT) is an academic test required for international teaching assistants (ITAs), i.e. graduate students who fit **both** of these categories:

- international graduate students who are not native speakers of American English (i.e., learned another language first), and
- international graduate students who are appointed to a teaching assistantship.

The OECT is administered before the beginning of fall and spring semesters for first-time test-takers, as well as at the end of these semesters for ITAs re-taking the test. The OECT testing dates can be found on the International Teaching Assistants Program website at <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/speaking/oect-for-itas>. Registration for the OECT can be completed online through the program's website two to three weeks before the testing dates. International Teaching Assistants (ITAs) and faculty with questions about OECT should email itas@iastate.edu or call 515-294-1958 or 515-294-7996.

A prospective ITA who does not pass OECT is required to successfully complete English 180 coursework and be retested. English 180 is a series of oral communication courses designed to help ITAs improve their English speaking skills by focusing on pronunciation, listening, classroom-communication strategies, question-handling, teaching and lecturing skills, and the culture of U.S. university life (<https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/courses/speaking-courses>). Because enrollment is restricted, ITAs cannot register for English 180 courses online through AccessPlus. ITAs must go to the CCE in the Graduate College, 1137 Pearson, upon receiving the OECT scores to obtain permission to enter the course by completing an online schedule change form.

Graduate Assistantships

A limited number of graduate assistantships are available to qualified, full-time students on a competitive basis. Graduate assistantships may be research, or administrative appointments. Most assistantships are offered on a ¼-time basis (10 hours per week). Students may apply for assistantship positions when applying to their academic program or by completing the Graduate Assistantship Application available by contacting the Ivy Graduate Programs Office. Students are also encouraged to pursue assistantships throughout the university and associated centers.

The maximum length of time for which a student will be funded with a graduate assistantship is the expected time period for completion of the degree, which is four semesters except for MSIS which is 3 semesters. Additionally, you must maintain satisfactory work performance for renewal of your graduate assistantship appointment. Students may be required to work during break periods at the discretion of the supervising faculty. Students must remain in good academic standing (not on probation or warning) to maintain their assistantship. Students who are on probation or warning may not be eligible to continue on assistantship or may have their tuition scholarship revoked. All Ivy Graduate students must enroll in a minimum of 6 credits during the semesters they have their GA position.

Students awarded an assistantship will be required to complete an LOI and agree to the terms and conditions of the appointment (shared via email). Graduate assistants are required to submit weekly timesheets by midnight on Sundays. [A full overview of the Ivy Graduate Assistantship is available here.](#)

Graduate assistants are responsible for maintaining regular communication with their supervising faculty and to perform the duties assigned in a timely manner. Performance evaluation of graduate assistants is conducted each semester. Students who do not perform satisfactorily may jeopardize the renewal of their assistantship appointments.

All Ivy graduate students are expected to know and follow the [Ivy College of Business Professional Standards and Expectations](#) and [Iowa State University's Principles of Community](#).

Graduate College Handbook

In addition to this Ivy Program Handbook, the Graduate College provides a university-wide handbook. The Graduate College Handbook is a comprehensive resource for policies and procedures that pertain to graduate students and postdoctoral scholars. Members of the graduate faculty craft policies through their elective representatives on the Graduate Council. Faculty and staff in the Graduate College implement the policies as efficiently and fairly as possible. Students and faculty are invited to collaborate with their representatives on the Graduate Council to enact policy changes that may improve graduate education at Iowa State University. [View the Graduate College Handbook here.](#)

ISUCard

The [ISUCard](#) is your student identification card. Your nine-digit, student ID is the middle set of numbers on your ISUCard. You can obtain your card at the ISUCard Office located in 0530 Beardshear Hall. Distance students are not required to have an ISU card, but they may obtain one. Please call the ISU Card Office for more information, 515-294-2727.

Orientation: Ivy Graduate New Student

For all new students, the Ivy graduate student experience begins with new student orientation.

- Full-time graduate students will have orientation on campus in Ames on the Friday prior to the start of the semester. During orientation, students will attend informational sessions providing helpful tools to begin their graduate coursework, and become acquainted with Ivy faculty, staff, and classmates.
- Full-time Ivy MBA students will have orientation during the first week of the semester on campus in Ames. This orientation will allow students to become acquainted with the Ivy MBA faculty, staff, and classmates and will build the foundation for success in the Ivy MBA program.
- Professional MBA students will attend orientation during the first week of the semester in the evenings at the Ivy Professional MBA classroom suite located in the Capital Square Building in Des Moines. The PMBA orientation will provide helpful information, allow students to become acquainted with Ivy MBA faculty, staff, and classmates, and allow for networking opportunities.
- New students in online programs will have orientation information provided in Canvas, the online learning platform, along with a welcome and kick off in August with their DOGES, staff and classmates, virtually.

Textbooks

Textbooks and course packets for classes can be ordered through University Book Store by logging into AccessPlus or via the book store website: www.isubookstore.com.

Academic Matters

Grade Reports

Semester grades typically become available one week following the end of each term. Students can obtain final grades reports on AccessPlus. Block 3 courses that end after the traditional 16-week semester will have grades submitted manually at the end of the course.

Please note that concurrent students (with undergraduate coursework taken simultaneously with graduate coursework) will need to complete a [Transfer of Courses for Concurrent Bachelors/Graduate Degree form](#) to move courses between their undergraduate and graduate record. Once the form is submitted, this process is done by hand by the Registrar's Office and can take 10+days to be updated after grade day.

Enrollment Requirements

During the academic year, graduate students not on assistantship must be registered for a minimum of nine credits to be considered full-time students or five credits to be considered half-time students. Students on an assistantship appointment during the academic year are considered full-time. International students enrolled in a residential, on-campus program must take at least 6 credits in-person each semester.

Credit Limits

Course registration is limited to a maximum of 15 credits per semester (10 credits for summer session)

for graduate students. Maximum limits for graduate students can be found in the Graduate College Handbook under section 2.1.6. The credit-hour limits for graduate students may be exceeded only in exceptional circumstances with the written recommendation of the major professor. For more information on registration requirements for those students on assistantship appointments, see Graduate Students on Assistantship in Chapter 3.

To request an increase to your credit limit, please contact your Ivy academic advisor.

Independent Study

The pedagogical intent of the Independent Study, 590, course is to provide an individualized project/research experience for MBA students guided by a faculty in the Ivy College of Business. Each independent study must generate a research project and a documented academic paper under the direction of the faculty member. It is the faculty member's prerogative to agree or not to serve as a project advisor.

Employment and internships do not constitute in and of themselves a sufficient basis for independent study credit. If the experience generates research project potential, then credit may be negotiated.

In general, if a program requires experiential credit, the student may register for either BUSAD 590 or BUSAD 591, according to the DOGE's direction. For a 3-credit experience, a student must work 120 hours over 12 weeks (10 hours/week, which is equivalent to 40 hours/per credit). While specific outcomes and deliverables are determined by the faculty and DOGE, it is recommended that in addition to the hours worked, a student also submit a 3–5-page summary of experience, gives a final presentation/sales plan (or another final assignment agreed upon by instructor/employers).

To enroll in an independent study, students must first complete the Independent Study Request Form available in the Graduate Business Programs Office or at:

<https://iastate.app.box.com/file/822388989832?s=rcim53h3r1vx9whzcpb4dihdb4wmuemx>

The completed and signed request form is then submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office to receive course registration information. A maximum of three credits of independent study may be applied towards degree requirements.

Employer Tuition Reimbursement and Early Release of Grades

Students participating in an employer tuition reimbursement program may request an early grade confirmation letter. Students will need to contact their course instructor(s) and request that final grade(s) be reported to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office before an early grade confirmation letter can be prepared.

Tuition

Tuition information is provided by the Office of the Registrar. A breakdown of fees is available on their [website](#). Tuition and Fees are applied directly to your university bill, which can be found on AccessPlus. Fall and spring semester tuition and fees are based on credit load at 5:00 p.m. on the 10th day of class. This is the last day for adjustments downward in tuition and fee assessment.

Progressing Through Your Program

Academic Progress

Ivy graduate students are expected to make satisfactory academic progress during their graduate business studies. Students are placed on academic probation if their cumulative GPA falls below 3.00, and a hold is placed on future class registrations. Students on academic probation must consult with their academic advisor or DOGE to develop a plan for academic improvement and receive permission for continued enrollment in the program. Students who are on assistantships must remain in good academic standing (not on probation or warning) to maintain their assistantship. Students who are on probation or warning may not be eligible to continue on assistantship or may have their tuition scholarship revoked.

Graduate students must complete all courses listed on their program of study with at least a C grade in each course and have achieved a minimum cumulative GPA of 3.00 to graduate.

Commencement

Graduation is a time of celebration of your academic accomplishments so participation in commencement ceremonies is highly encouraged. As an Ivy graduate student, you have a lot to celebrate! We know you've put in many hours of study, and we are so proud of you! Invite your family, friends, and cheering section to join you. At the Ivy College of Business convocation, hosted at Hilton Coliseum, your Ivy faculty and staff will be there to congratulate you and your peers.

During the 60–75-minute ceremony, you'll sit with other students in your program, cross the stage as your name is read, have your picture taken, and receive a small gift. Seating is unlimited at Hilton and tickets are not required for admission. You'll be invited to RSVP through email two or three weeks prior to convocation.

Diplomas are not handed out at the Ivy College of Business convocation ceremony, but rather can be:

- Picked up by the graduate in [214 Enrollment Services](#), or
- Mailed to you two to three weeks after graduation. [Learn more here](#).

Want more celebration? Consider attending the [university graduate college ceremony](#). If you are a concurrent undergraduate/graduate student, you may also attend your [undergraduate program's convocation](#) event. There are many options for you to select from, but please RSVP so that event coordinators know to expect you. Approximately six weeks after the start of the semester, the "diploma/ceremony" option under "graduation" on AccessPlus will become available. At this time, you will be able to sign up for the ceremony, the college convocation, as well as the diploma delivery option.

Students who graduate in the summer have the option to attend the spring or the fall ceremony. Make sure you apply for summer since that is when you will complete all degree requirements. If you choose to walk in the spring, the "diploma/ceremony" option will be available in March. If you choose to walk in the fall ceremony, that option will be available in mid-June.

Graduates must wear full regalia for university ceremonies. You can rent or purchase your regalia at the [University Bookstore](#). The Ivy Graduate Programs Office has a limited number of master's graduation

hoods which are loaned to graduates on a first-come, first-served basis.

[Watch a quick tutorial on how to wear your regalia.](#)

Ivy graduate students will wear the following regalia:

- Masters gown
- Drab masters hood
- Cap
- Black tassel

Iowa State University nor the Ivy College of Business does not hold commencement ceremonies in the summer. However, summer graduates may participate in either the previous spring or following fall university commencements.

Learn more about graduation at the [university's graduation FAQ](#) page.

Degree Completion

Ivy graduate students are expected to complete their programs in a timely manner. Full-time students need to be aware that prolonging graduation beyond the expected completion time period is unacceptable and will only be granted for valid academic reasons such as a semester co-op or internship experience. Students who plan to extend their studies beyond the intended timelines must submit a request in writing explaining the rationale for the extension and their expected date of graduation.

The Graduate College's time-to-degree limit for all graduate students, both master's and Ph.D., is seven years.

Graduation Procedures

The Application for Graduation is due by the end of the first week of the semester you plan to graduate. [View these Graduate College deadlines here.](#) Your POSC must be approved before submitting an Application for Graduation. The graduation application can be found on AccessPlus.

Ivy graduates are asked to complete an employment survey, administered by Graduate Business Career Services, late in the semester of graduation.

As you approach graduation, there are important steps you'll need to follow. Students are encouraged to complete these steps as early in the semester as possible. See [full details on the Graduate College's graduation process.](#)

1) Program of Study Committee (POSC), due semester prior to graduation

- POSC form is available in AccessPlus > Student > Grad Stdnt Status > My POSC Form.
- POSC must be approved by the Graduate College no later than the end of the term before your graduation term. For example, if you plan to graduate in May 2024 (end of spring semester), plan to work on this over Thanksgiving break.

2) Once POSC is approved, apply for graduation, due semester prior to graduation

- Apply for graduation (regardless of whether you will attend the in-person ceremony) through AccessPlus at the "Grad Stdnt Status" page.

3) Are you a Masters of Information Systems (MSIS) major? If yes, go to Step 4. All other majors, skip to Step 6.

4) Schedule your final oral exam with your committee and once scheduled, submit a request for final

oral examination to the Graduate College; it will vary each semester, a request must be submitted three weeks prior (no late requests will be accepted.)

- Submit the final oral [Online Examination Request](#) form to the Graduate College **at least three weeks prior** to your scheduled exam. Students who do not meet this deadline will have their graduation cancelled by the Graduate College.

5) Submit your creative component to ISU Digital Repository

- Create an account in the [ISU Digital Repository](#)
- Submit your creative component to the Graduate College via the [Creative Component Submission](#) form.
- The Graduate College requires all students to submit their creative component, but they do not review the contents. Meaning, if your committee has approved your final oral exam/graduation, this is what determines if you have successfully completed the program.

6) Final Steps

- [Information about the commencement ceremony](#)
- [Graduation checklist](#) (where you want your diploma sent, transcript information, etc.)

Program of Study

Ivy graduate students must complete a program of study/committee (POSC) form no later than the semester prior to the expected term of graduation. The POSC lists the courses taken (or will be taken), credit hours, and grades earned to date to fulfill the degree requirements. The POSC is reviewed by your advisor/DOGE to ensure degree requirements have been met.

Modifications to the POSC are possible even after it has been reviewed and approved by the Ivy Graduate Programs Office. The POSC form can be found on AccessPlus.

A delay in graduation will occur if the POSC is not forwarded for final approval to the Iowa State University Graduate College by the specified deadline date so timely submission to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office is very important. [View these Graduate College deadlines here](#).

Ivy students who have questions about their POSC should consult with their advisor. Once you complete your POSC, you may apply for graduation on AccessPlus. This cannot be done until your POSC form is submitted and approved.

Student Life

Graduate Lounge

All Ivy College of Business graduate students have access to the Tahira and Labh Hira Graduate Student Lounge. The lounge is located at room 2141 Gerdin and can be accessed using your ISU card. Just click your ISU card on the dark grey box near the door, and you are in!

The Lounge is a great place to meet for group projects, work on individual assignments, eat a meal, or grab a quick nap between classes.

The lounge includes:

- tables, chairs and a couch
- microwave
- refrigerator and freezer

- two desktop computers with free access to a printer

MBASMA Student Association

All Ivy Graduate students are encouraged to join the MBA and Specialty Masters Association. MBASMA members are actively engaged in planning activities and events that complement the classroom experience of the students. The MBASMA organizes events to promote diversity and cultural awareness, networking, and social interactions among students in the professional masters programs.

Ivy Graduate students can further develop their leadership skills by holding key officer positions in the MBASMA Association. [Learn more about the organization here.](#)

The Community

All Graduate Students in the Ivy College of Business have access to “The Community”, which is an online portal for sharing onboarding information, university and college support opportunities, announcements, and program resources. Students can access the portal through Canvas and are added to the Community at the start of their program. Students are encouraged to check back frequently to the portal so that students stay up to date on what's happening in their program.

Student Rights and Responsibilities

Academic Grievance Procedures (Grades and Instruction)

Source: Graduate College Handbook, sec. 9.5.1

If a graduate student contends that a faculty member, in his or her academic capacity as a course instructor, has behaved unfairly or unprofessionally, a grievance may be reviewed through the procedure described below. This procedure may not be invoked more than one year following completion of the course. An appeal of a course grade must be initiated by midterm of the semester following the student’s completion of the course.

- o If the dispute or perceived violation does not directly involve the graduate student’s major professor, the graduate student is encouraged to contact his or her major professor.
- o The graduate student may contact the Graduate and Professional Student Senate (GPSS) by contacting the senator representing the student’s academic unit or the GPSS president. The GPSS will represent the best interests of the student and may serve as a liaison between the student and the appropriate University administration and offices.
- o The graduate student may contact Student Assistance staff within the Dean of Student’s Office.
- o Students may contact the Dean of the Graduate College to pursue informal dispute resolution.
- o Graduate students are encouraged to contact the Ombuds Office for unbiased and neutral assessment for informal resolution of a dispute.
- o Concerns of discrimination, harassment, and/or sexual misconduct do not fall within these procedures, and instead should be reported to the Office of Equal Opportunity as soon as possible.

Before initiating a formal appeal, the student may wish to discuss the situation informally with a staff member of the Dean of Students Office for advice on how to deal most effectively with the problem.

Academic grievances should be resolved, if possible, with the individual instructor involved. If a resolution cannot be reached, the student should discuss the grievance with the instructor's department chair and submit it in writing to him or her. The department chair will discuss the grievance with the instructor involved and/or refer it to a department grievance committee. The department chair should respond in writing to the student within five class days.

If a resolution of the grievance cannot be made with the department chair, the student may appeal in writing to the dean of the instructor's college. In cases involving Graduate College policy or procedure, the appeal should be made to the Dean of the Graduate College. The dean will hear the explanations of the department chair and instructor and should respond in writing within ten class days of receipt of the written notice of appeal.

If the grievance cannot be resolved with the dean, the student may forward a written appeal to the Provost, who will convene a quorum of the Committee to Review Student Grievances to hear the appeal within ten class days. Within five class days following the hearing, the Provost will make a decision regarding the grievance and transmit this decision to the student, dean, department chair, and instructor involved. An appeal of the decision of the Provost may be made to the President of the University.

The time limit specified at each level may be extended by mutual agreement of all parties concerned.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity might best be defined, quite simply, as doing one's own academic work without unauthorized assistance from other persons or resources. More specifically, academic integrity means that students take their coursework seriously and place significant value on learning and engagement in the classroom and while completing assignments and projects. Alleged academic misconduct is subject to Student Disciplinary Regulations outlined in the University's [Student Code of Conduct](#).

Visit the Iowa State University Dean of Students Office website for more information about student conduct: www.studentconduct.dso.iastate.edu/academic-misconduct/armstu. Read more about the [academic conduct expectations of Iowa State students here](#).

Discrimination and Harassment Policy

In accordance with federal and state law, Iowa State University ("ISU" or the "university") does not discriminate on the basis of age, color, creed, disability, gender identity, genetic information, national origin, pregnancy, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, and protected U.S. veteran status (collectively referred to as "Protected Status") in its programs, activities, or employment.

This policy prohibits all forms of unlawful discrimination and harassment based on Protected Status. In addition, this policy prohibits purposefully assisting in an act that violates this policy (i.e., complicity) and prohibits retaliation against any individual who in good faith participates in protected activity pursuant to this policy. This policy also provides for the prompt and equitable resolution of reports of discrimination, harassment, complicity, and retaliation. The university's [Office of Equal Opportunity \(OEO\)](#) is responsible for administering this policy on behalf of the university.

All ISU administration, supervisors, faculty, staff, and students are responsible for successfully

completing the university's annual non-discrimination, anti-harassment, and anti-retaliation training program. The training program is specifically designed for its target audience (e.g., students, staff, faculty, supervisors, etc.) and is intended to assist university community members in understanding this policy.

The university has a separate policy that governs concerns of Title IX sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, and stalking. These concerns are governed by the university's [Title IX Sexual Harassment, Sexual Assault, Dating Violence, Domestic Violence, and Stalking Policy](#). Nothing in this policy shall be deemed to conflict, contradict, or supersede the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy with respect to conduct governed by that policy. The university also has a separate [Non-Retaliation Policy](#) that prohibits prohibited retaliation against persons who engage in protected activity.

A complete text of Iowa State University discrimination and harassment policy can be found at: www.policy.iastate.edu/policy/discrimination/#Statement.

Plagiarism

"Simply put, plagiarism is making use of other people's ideas, words, creative works and expressions without giving credit or otherwise listing the source of the information. Plagiarism is stealing. Plagiarism is also misrepresentation, and includes handing in someone else's work, ideas, or answers as your own. Regardless of whether it happens inadvertently through sloppy research or on purpose through unethical behavior, it is plagiarism just the same and the person plagiarizing will be held liable." Alleged academic misconduct, such as plagiarism is subject to Student Disciplinary Regulations outlined the University's [Student Code of Conduct](#). Read more about the [academic conduct expectations of Iowa State students here](#).

Best practices for avoiding plagiarism can be found here. Source: Iowa State University e-Library website: <http://instr.iastate.libguides.com/content.php?pid=10314>

Professionalism

Ivy MBA students are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that upholds high standards of professionalism. These standards must provide a foundation for your actions inside and outside the classroom. Students committing unprofessional or unethical acts, whether from carelessness, ignorance, or malice, quickly lose the respect of their peers and others.

If you witness unprofessional or unethical acts, you should first address the issue with the individual(s) involved. Acts of a serious nature must be discussed with the Director of Professional Masters Student Services or the Associate Dean for Academic Affairs. In all cases, prompt attention to the issue at hand is desired to maintain the cohesiveness of the Ivy MBA student body and the integrity of the program.

Smartphones, Laptops, and other Electronic Devices

Beginning in fall 2020, all students at Iowa State University are required to own or obtain a laptop computer or other device appropriate to their discipline. The use of computers is integral to the learning process at the university and students need to acquire these skills to compete professionally and to co-exist socially. [Read more about the university's computer requirement and additional resources here](#).

In the Ivy College of Business laptops and tablets are permitted in class for notetaking only. Other

activities such as checking personal e-mail or browsing the Internet are prohibited. Smartphones and other electronic devices must be turned off (or on vibrate) and hidden from view during class time.

Program Overview

Introduction

The Ivy College of Business at Iowa State University launched the Master of Business Administration (MBA) in 1985 as a resident full-time program. In 1991, the business faculty approved a team-focused, cohort program still followed today. Along with the cohort model came an integrated and sequential core curriculum designed to best deliver the common body of knowledge in business. Specializations in the MBA program began to proliferate into a variety of areas deemed central to the college and university mission, as well as into areas of interest to MBA students and recruiters.

In 1992, a Saturday MBA program in Ames was started with a structure similar and a curriculum identical to the resident, full-time MBA. This part-time, weekend program was created in response to strategic initiatives for the college to become more active in executive education.

In 1999, an evening MBA in downtown Des Moines was launched with courses taught by the same faculty teaching in the on-campus MBA programs. This new part-time MBA program was established for employed professionals in the greater Des Moines and Central Iowa areas. The Saturday MBA program was discontinued in 2009 because of difficulties sustaining two, part-time MBA programs. In 2020, the PMBA transitioned the MBA core classes to a hybrid model, moving classes to meeting one day a week in person with an online component. In the fall 2022, the PMBA responded to student feedback that the program needed increased flexibility with its offerings and delivery options. To accommodate, the PMBA program moved to a team-based course structure from the cohort model, allowing students to take MBA core classes in a customized-fashion, rather than in a set order. This also allowed students to select from 1-3 classes a semester, rather than a prescribed order. In the fall 2023, the PMBA program added an online delivery method, and reduced total credit requirement from 48 credits to 42 credits. The Professional MBA in Des Moines continues to serve the Central Iowa business community today.

Now in existence for nearly 35 years, the Iowa State University Ivy MBA has undergone numerous restructurings and curricular changes commensurate with the strategic directions of the Ivy College of Business, advances in instructional technology, and the dynamic graduate business education market. Yet the core principle of offering an unsurpassed MBA experience through a team-focused, cohort structure remains unchanged.

The learning goals of the Iowa State Ivy MBA program are to:

- o Ivy MBA students will demonstrate effective communication skills
- o Ivy MBA students will effectively lead and work in diverse teams
- o Ivy MBA students will critically solve business problems
- o Ivy MBA students will be able to integrate ethical and global perspectives in decision making

We welcome you to the Iowa State University Ivy MBA program. We are committed to providing you with a rewarding and valuable educational experience.

The Successful Start Program for the MBA and PMBA Program

The Iowa State Ivy MBA “Successful Start Program” helps to ensure you experience a positive transition into the program. To accomplish this goal, the Ivy College of Business has partnered with Harvard Business Publishing to offer online preparatory courses in **spreadsheet modeling, financial accounting, finance, calculus, quantitative methods, and presentation skills**. These short courses will prove beneficial if you do not have an academic background in business, or you need a quick refresher.

The Iowa State University Ivy MBA faculty will assume you are proficient in the fundamentals of the subjects mentioned above. So, you must complete these preparatory courses if needed.

Ivy MBA Degree Requirements

The Ivy MBA requires a minimum of 48 credit hours consisting of ten required, core courses (30 credits) and four elective courses (18 credits). Subjects covered in the MBA core include financial accounting, organizational behavior, managerial economics, quantitative business analysis, finance, marketing, management information systems, supply chain management, professional responsibilities in business and society, and strategy.

Waiver of Iowa State MBA core courses is rare and requires special permission from the course instructor. A waived core course requires a replacement elective with the equivalent credit hours.

The MBA core curriculum is taught in a sequential series of pedagogical building blocks forming a solid foundation of business knowledge and skills. Each MBA core course covers six weeks, meeting once per week. Class sessions are three hours and twenty minutes each.

Full-time MBA students also take two “R” credit professional skills development courses during their first year of the Ivy MBA program.

MBA specializations are offered in accounting analytics, accounting, business analytics, entrepreneurship, finance, healthcare analytics and operations, information systems, leadership, marketing real estate and supply chain management. Each specialization requires nine credits consisting of approved coursework within the focus area. Students may pursue a double specialization; however, no more than one approved elective (3 credits) may be applied to both specializations.

MBA students may also add a Graduate Certificate to their study plan. The Ivy College of Business offers Graduate Certificates in Business Analytics, Digital Marketplace (this is a 15-credit certificate), Enterprise Cybersecurity Management, Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Finance, Leadership, and Supply Chain Management.

Ivy Graduate Certificates require 12-15 credits of which all 12-15 credits can be applied as MBA electives, with advisor approval. Certificates may be earned before, after, or concurrently with a master’s or doctoral degree. Credit from a previously earned master’s or doctoral degree from Iowa State University cannot be applied toward a future Ivy certificate.

Students need to work closely with their advisor to develop a study plan and to ensure degree

requirements are being met.

Ivy MBA Elective Policy Guidelines

The Ivy MBA requires students to satisfactorily complete four elective courses (12 credits). You may choose an area of specialization; however, you are also expected to maintain sufficient breadth in your selection of elective coursework. A specialization is not required in the Ivy MBA.

To maintain sufficient breadth when selecting elective courses, you must choose elective coursework from at least two academic disciplines in the Ivy College of Business.

Academic disciplines are generally identified by these course designations: ACCT, FIN, ENSTSP, HCM, MGMT, MKT, MIS, and SCM. MGMT electives include multiple academic disciplines (e.g., strategy, human resources, entrepreneurship). Business analytics is also considered an academic discipline appearing under multiple course designators (e.g., MIS, MKT). BUSAD special topics courses may fall under a specific academic discipline or may be interdisciplinary depending upon the course topic. Talk with your MBA adviser if you have questions.

Students may request a waiver for BUSAD 502 if they have credit for a 300-level or higher Statistics course in which they've earned a B or higher within the last 4 years. Students who have their waiver approved must select one, three-credit MBA elective in its place to earn 48 total credits for the MBA degree.

Except for bachelor's degree-seeking students enrolled in an MBA concurrent degree program, MBA students are generally expected to take graduate level business courses (numbered 500 and above) as MBA electives. Undergraduate level courses (numbered 400 or below) require academic adviser approval.

All MBA students must include at least four 500 level elective courses from the Ivy College of Business in their program of study. MBA study tours are also considered elective courses. There is no limit to the number of study tours on a student's MBA program of study.

Concurrent MBA students are limited to three 400-level courses or two 400-level courses and one 300-level course on their MBA program of study. These courses must be approved by concurrent MBA students' undergraduate and MBA advisers. No more than 12 credits can be shared between the undergraduate degree and MBA for concurrently enrolled students.

The Ivy MBA allows for some flexibility in tailoring the selection of electives toward students' academic and career goals. Up to two of the six MBA electives may be from approved coursework taken outside the Ivy College of Business.

Normally, outside electives appear on an MBA student's program of study from:

- o Courses applying to both a bachelor's degree and the MBA in an established concurrent degree program
- o Transfer courses taken while enrolled as an MBA student (or pre-MBA) at another AACSB-accredited business school (time limitations apply)
- o Approved graduate level courses from another Iowa State University academic department or regionally accredited U.S. institution

MBA Transfer Credits

Transfer of MBA course credits from other academic institutions to the Ivy MBA is limited and requires approval to be included on a student's study plan. The university must have AACSB accreditation for transfer credit to be considered. The length of time since the requested transfer courses were taken is also a factor. Generally, transfer credit applies to elective coursework, not the required core courses, within the Ivy MBA program. Per University policy, at least 22 graduate credits must be earned at Iowa State University.

Up to 24 transfer credits from an Iowa Board of Regents Institution are allowed to transfer into the fulltime MBA. For the Professional MBA, up to 18 transfer credits from an Iowa Board of Regents Institution are allowed to transfer in. Up to 9 credits from an AACSB accredited institution may transfer into the fulltime MBA program or PMBA. Generally, transfer credit applies to elective coursework, not to required core courses. Courses are evaluated on a case-by-case basis.

Coursework taken as an undergraduate student is not transferrable to the MBA program. A final course grade of "B" or higher must be received on all transfer coursework. An official graduate transcript from the institution from which transfer credit has been approved must be submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office.

International Study Opportunities

Ivy MBA students are encouraged to consider international study as part of their MBA experience. International study opportunities provide valuable insights into global business practices and a heightened awareness of cultural diversity. MBA faculty lead a global study tour each year. Visit your MBA academic adviser about the annual study tour and other study abroad opportunities.

MBA Case Competitions

Full-time MBA students participate in a team case competition at the conclusion of their core courses. This culminating event allows students to apply the knowledge and skills learned in their core courses to a real-world scenario.

The Ivy College of Business and the ISU Pappajohn Center for Entrepreneurship host the annual Ivy MBA Mind to Market Case Challenge each spring.

Ivy MBA teams also participate in external case competitions held on campuses throughout the country.

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